

L2A™

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this marginQ4. (a) Discuss the major modes of livelihood in human societies with ethnographic examples
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There are various modes of livelihoods in human societies with various factors acting on them.

Major modes of livelihoods

1) Hunting and gathering

- oldest type of subsistence system
- characterised by simple mode of production, distribution and immediate consumption
- Examples

→ Onge, Jarawa, Sentinelese (India)
 → Inuits (Alaska)
 → !Kung (Africa)
- Primitive technology, division of labour based on age and sex.
- lives in bands, carry least possession
- egalitarian society.

2) Fishing

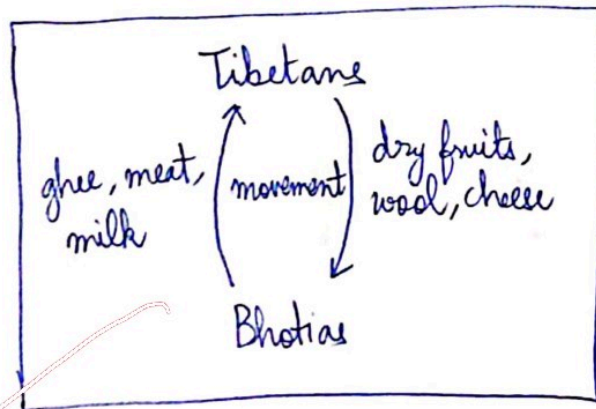
→ 2nd oldest subsistence system (11000 yrs old)

→ Examples → copper eskimos (Alaska)
→ coastal Dohamecans (W. Africa)
→ Solomon Islanders (Oceania)

- dense population and sedentary life
- use of complex technology - kayaks, nets, boats.
- protein rich diet, + storage of food.
- presence of formal political leadership.

3) Pastoralists

- characterised by livestock rearing
- usually mobile
- ~~Domestication~~ seasonal and pendulous movement
- production of fur, milk, wool
- Tools include basket, knives, pots.



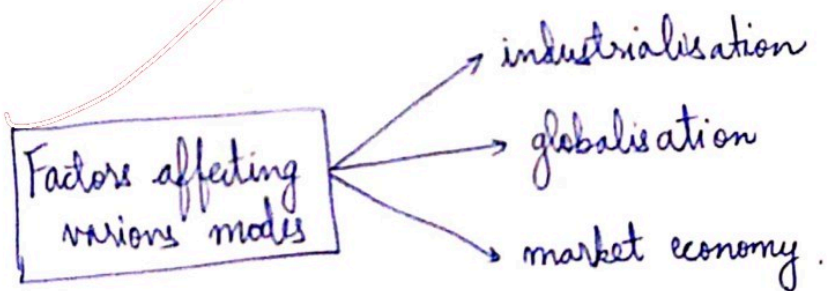
- Examples
 - Masai (Africa)
 - Chukchee (Russia)
 - Toda, Kuxumba, Kota, Bhotia (India)

- Religion is polytheistic and animism.
- The main aim of justice is not to punish the guilty but to restore harmony.

4) Agriculture

- cultivation of crops, livestock rearing and marketing of products
- sedentary life.

- Examples : Santhal, Gond, Naga, Meitei (India)
- use of ~~the~~ mechanised technology to cultivate crops
- economy of surplus which is sold in market
- consumption is not immediate
- Domestication of animals.
- Presence of tribal political authority



Due to cultural contact and penetration of new forces, these modes of livelihoods are experiencing changes.

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